- Use `auth` middleware to protect routes
- Configure Laravel to use SQLite as the database

13.8.3 Prerequisites

Before you begin, make sure you have the following:

- PHP 8.2 or higher
- Composer
- Node.js and npm
- SQLite already installed
- Laravel 12 installed
- Visual Studio Code or any text editor

> *This lab uses **PHP 8.4**, **Laravel 12** and **Visual Studio Code** as the primary editor.*

13.8.4 Steps

Here are the steps to complete this lab:

13.8.4.1 Step 1: Create New Laravel Project

We can create a new Laravel project using the Laravel installer:

```
laravel new auth-lab
cd auth-lab
code .
```

Accept all the default options during installation. This will create a new Laravel project named `auth-lab` and use SQLite as the default database. The last command will open the project in Visual Studio Code.

You should see the project in Visual Studio Code.

13.8.4.2 Step 2: Configure SQLite Database

Since we use default SQLite database, we don't do anything. We can verify this by checking the `.env` file. Open the `.env` file and check the following lines:

```
DB_CONNECTION=sqlite
```